



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

National Police College of Jamaica Quality Assessment Policy

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1.0 INTRODUCTION

Assessments must be designed to contribute to high quality participant learning and underpin the development, delivery and quality assurance of modules and courses. Assessment should both help participants learn (assessment for learning) and measure explicit evidence of their learning (assessment of learning).

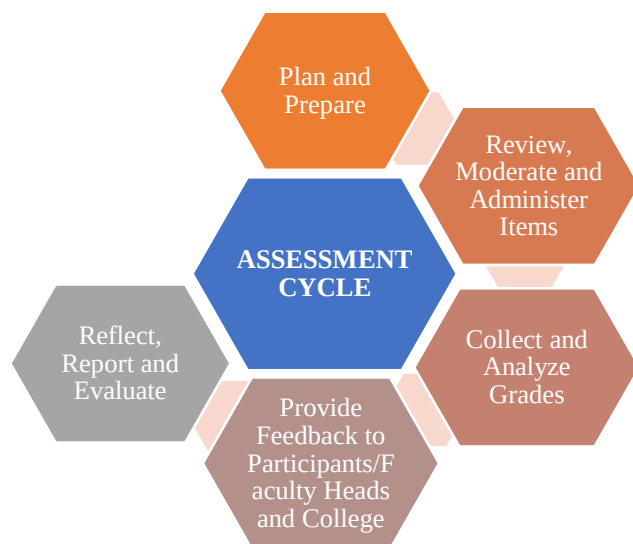
Assessment:

- a. must be criterion-referenced and standard-based and provides evidence of the level of achievement with respect to learning outcomes and participant attributes;
- b. must be a transparent process carried out with honesty, integrity and confidentiality in line with the Mission of the NPCJ;
- c. is integral to andragogic informed learning and training;
- d. must comprise a variety of tasks which are reasonably achievable by participants; and
- e. must be fair, inclusive and equitable for all participants.

Assessment includes:

- a. design and specification of activities or tasks that participants undertake to support their learning; whether internal or external; formative or summative;
- b. provision of feedback as guidance for participants' learning;
- c. moderation of assessment activities;
- d. award of marks or grades; and
- e. determination and award of final result grades.

The diagram below summarizes the entire assessment process. This allows for participants, facilitators and heads of faculties to adequately quality assure the assessment standards.



2.0 PURPOSE OF ASSESSMENT POLICY AT THE NPCJ

This policy sets out the principles that underpin NPCJ's approach to assessment. Thus, it is incumbent on the NPCJ as the entity charged with the training, development and education of Police Officers in Jamaica to have in place effective procedures for:

- a. designing, approving, monitoring and reviewing the assessment strategies for programmes and courses;
- b. implementing rigorous assessment policies and practices that ensure the standard for each course element is set and maintained at the appropriate level, and that participant performance is properly judged against this;
- c. evaluating how training standards are maintained through assessment practice, which also serves to encourage effective learning.

3.0 SCOPE

This policy applies to:

- a. all coursework modules offered across the NPCJ;
- b. participants undertaking such modules;
- c. academic and/or professional staff with responsibility for designing, administering or making decisions relating to assessments.

4.0 POLICY STATEMENTS

Assessment is a core learning and training activity and an essential component of the process at the NPCJ, therefore:

- a. Assessment practices should promote participant engagement, support participant learning and judge levels of performance.
- b. Assessment tasks should be aligned with the course's objectives and teaching and learning arrangements.
- c. Assessment design should provide participants with the stimulus to learn in depth, apply their developing skills and knowledge in new situations, and challenge and change their ways of thinking and doing.
- d. All assessment models have limitations. A variety of assessment techniques should be used within a course.
- e. Assessment should be used for both formative and summative assessment purposes.
- f. Staff and participants should engage in the Assessment process with the utmost ethical academic conduct.

5.0 INTERPRETATIONS/DEFINITIONS

The following words and expressions when used in this policy have the meanings listed below:

- 5.1 **Assessment:** Also refers to all coursework (formative) and examinations (summative) done internally and externally. Assessment is the process of evaluating participants' performance to ascertain the extent to which they have met the prescribed learning outcomes of the task (and thus contribute to the achievement of the learning outcomes of the Module and the course/programme). Assessment enables participants to monitor their progress and determines the academic results in a Module or course/programme.
- 5.2 **Assessment schedule:** The series of activities and tasks comprising the total assessment for a Module or course/programme.
- 5.3 **Candidate:** Participants completing an examination Criterion-referenced assessment: Assessment based on pre-determined and clearly articulated criteria which are directly drawn from the module learning outcomes and not based on the achievement of other participants.
- 5.4 **Course Staff:** Facilitators, Programme/Course Coordinators/Training Officers/Syndicate Directors
- 5.5 **Deadline/Due date:** The date and time by which an assessment task must be submitted.
- 5.6 **Examinees:** These are the enrolled participants of a course or programme who will be sitting or in the process of sitting an examination.

- 5.7 **Ethical Academic Conduct:** This is carrying oneself with honesty, fairness and equity in interpersonal, professional and academic relationships
- 5.8 **Learning outcomes:** These are the expression of the set of knowledge, skills and the application of the knowledge and skills a person has acquired and is able to demonstrate as a result of learning.
- 5.9 **Lecturer:** Refers to Facilitator, Tutor, Instructor, Trainer and Presenter
- 5.10 **Major Assessment:** One worth 30% or more of the total assessments and includes high level research and practical activities.
- 5.11 **Moderation (of assessment):** A quality review and assurance process which supports assessment design and marking activities. It involves confirmation that the assessment tasks and marking are valid, equitable and reliable.
- 5.12 **Policy:** The rules and blueprint that govern the assessment procedures of the NPCJ.
- 5.13 **Rubric:** A scoring tool that explicitly represents the performance expectations for an assignment or piece of work.
- 5.14 **Participant(s):** An individual or group duly accepted to participate in any seminar, workshop, course or programme. This term more specifically refers to Trainee Constables, Trainees, Learners, Students and Force Applicants as variously described by the individual Faculty/department.
- 5.15 **Practical Assessments:** These are assessments that require participants to actually do or use tools related to the field of training rather than with theory and ideas.

- 5.16 **Serving Members:** Members of the Jamaica Constabulary Force and its auxiliaries
- 5.17 **Standards:** A framework which explains what can be expected at different levels of achievement of a learning outcome.
- 5.18 **Table of Specifications:** The list of objectives accompanied by a description of the items to be done in an examination.

6.0 RESPONSIBILITIES

6.1 Dean, Academic Studies

- 6.1.1 Report to the Academic Board of the NPCJ on matters pertaining to the quality assurance of programmes and assessments;
- 6.1.2 Carry out training needs analysis, training impact evaluations and tracer studies to inform the process of training development and delivery;
- 6.1.3 Design assessment models that support the desired learning outcomes;
- 6.1.4 Oversee the assessment and evaluation process of all training activities.

6.2 The Quality Assurance Desk

The responsibilities of the Quality Assurance Desk will be to:

- 6.2.1 Review and make corrections or recommendations to an examination script as it relates to content and format;
- 6.2.2 Interface with training partners to benchmark research methodologies and best practices;
- 6.2.3 Review audit reports to note best practices identified for inclusion in training curriculum; and
- 6.2.4 Review assessment instruments and grading system to ensure consistency and compatibility with College standards.

6.3 The Assessment/Examination Unit

This unit should comprise a small group of facilitators for each course, consecutively, along with Programme Coordinators, Syndicate Directors and Course Staff. The Head of Faculty/Department or designate shall provide oversight to ensure the following:

- 6.3.1 Reviewing and commenting on the quality of the examination items and general structure
- 6.3.2 Preparation of examination timetables for participants and staff
- 6.3.3 Creation of seating plans for each examination room
- 6.3.4 Briefing of candidates, and staff of examination procedures
- 6.3.5 Checking and securely storing confidential examination materials
- 6.3.6 Administration and relevance of internal assessments
- 6.3.7 Ensure that all changes to examination regulations are available to the faculty/department and passed on to the relevant Heads of Faculty/Department and Course Staff, who will share with the Dean, Academic Studies.

6.4 Student Registry

- 6.4.1 Maintain participant records, including personal information, academic history, registration status, and other relevant training record data.
- 6.4.2 Register and withdraw participants.
- 6.4.3 Identify registration and withdrawal trends across the NPCJ.
- 6.4.4 Monitor participants' certification requirements.
- 6.4.5 Handle requests for participant training records and supply relevant documentation.

6.5 Appointments and Qualifications of Examiners

For every NPCJ Faculty/department, there shall be Primary Examiners and at least one Secondary/External Examiner who is external to the NPCJ but an existing or former member of the JCF with knowledge of the subject matter, JCF standard operating procedures and the laws of Jamaica or the specific content being examined.

6.6 The Primary Examiner

The Primary examiner can be the facilitator, trainer, and coordinator of modules, courses or programmes affiliated with particular Faculties/Department of the NPCJ. These persons normally create the examination scripts based on content, course and/or programmes they would have coordinated, developed and/or facilitated. The minimum experience and qualification normally required for a Primary Examiner include:

- a) At least three years' cumulative experience as an Instructor, or Trainer;
- b) A minimum of three years' experience in general policing (if the course or programme involves law enforcement procedures and/or processes);

- c) Qualification(s)/certification(s) based on the course or programme and the subject matter.

6.7 Duties and Responsibilities of the Primary Examiner

- a. Coordinate the creation and preparation of examination papers for all facilitated or content developed modules and courses involving assessment.
- b. Comply with all deadlines for the production of assessments.
- c. Acquire and maintain an up-to-date knowledge of the NPCJ's assessment system and guidelines
- d. Collect and share achievement data to enable the NPCJ to measure performance.
- e. Supply the Secondary Examiner with relevant samples of participant course work, examination scripts, etc. for the second marking process.
- f. Liaise with the Secondary/External Examiner(s) to obtain feedback on the second-marked examinations papers.

6.8 The Secondary/External Examiner

The Secondary Examiner is an individual who is not a facilitator or trainer delivering content on the module or course being assessed. They should be external to the NPCJ, but has experience and/or training in the areas being assessed. The Director of NPCJ shall assign him or her in alliance with the Heads of Faculties. The minimum experience and qualification normally required for a Secondary Examiner include:

- a) At least five years' experience as an Instructor, Trainer or Curriculum Development Specialist
- b) A minimum of three years' experience in general policing (if the course or programme involves law enforcement procedures and/or processes)
- c) Qualification(s)/certification(s) in and experiences with the subject matter being taught.

6.9 Secondary/External Examiner

- a. Identify gaps between ideal and actual performance and determine causes of discrepancies;
- b. Guide the review of examinations for assigned course(s) across NPCJ;
- c. Provide comments on the quality of the examination items and responses by participants;
- d. After reviewing the examination scripts, rubrics/answer key and answer booklets, the Secondary/External Examiner should return them to the Programme Coordinators' office for general dissemination of grades;
- e. If a change to the grade for more than five (5) marks is required, consultations with the head of faculty/department should be done to make a decision.

- f. If a change to the grade for less than five (5) marks has been made by this examiner, collaboration with the primary examiner and course staff should be done for a decision to be made. The course staff should write a report to the Head of Department explaining these changes.

NB: Participants should only be notified of their final grades.

7.0 ASSESSMENT DESIGN AND STRATEGY

7.1 Teaching and Assessment Strategy

To ensure NPCJ meets the requirements of the Force, the college has developed a training and assessment philosophy. For each course a training and assessment strategy must be aligned to the:

- | | |
|---|---|
| a) Course Title | j) Course Structure (Weekly overview of objectives and topics to be covered) |
| b) Duration | k) Assessment Strategy (Assignment Type, Description and Score) |
| c) Contact Hours | l) Reading Materials and Resources (Primary and Secondary Reading Material) |
| d) Target Group/Population | m) Legislative requirements – Copyright, Plagiarism Statements, JCF Policy Mandates |
| e) Entry Requirements/Prerequisite Knowledge: | n) Rubrics |
| f) Methods of Instruction/Delivery | |
| g) Rationale | |
| h) Aim | |
| i) General Objectives | |

7.1.1 NPCJ will strive to maintain completed documents (course outline, assessment schedules, course materials – presentations, rubrics, etc. and course reports¹) for each course and provide copies of these to relevant personnel. For most courses at the NPCJ, participants and participants will be assessed on a continuous basis. Most courses will, however, have final examinations, to ensure that the students'/participants' level of knowledge and competency in skills required for the practice of policing are adequate.

7.1.2 Assessment is to be conducted according to the outline in the course document (course outline, training guide or curriculum), table of specifications, course materials and in relation to the standards set out by JCF Policies and Standard Operating Procedures. It is important that all assessments are guided by currency, validity and authenticity as evidenced by their adherence to the above standards; hence, the chosen format of the assessment must be appropriate to the target knowledge, skills and attitudes (KSAs) - competencies in the course documents. Assessment materials must be presented in clear and unambiguous language and must differentiate only on the basis of students'/ participants' achievement of the KSAs.

7.1.3 Assessment evidence will be judged according to the principles of:

- Currency- evidence should prove that the participant is competent or incompetent now.
- Validity – evidence should be appropriate and relevant to the competency/standards it is addressing.

c. Authenticity – evidence must reflect the exact knowledge /skills / attitude of the participant.

7.1.4 In creating an assessment strategy that is current, valid and authentic, it is imperative for the development of the varying assessments to be descriptive and in accordance with the learning outcomes for each participant. Here are a few of the assessment methodologies which are to be employed by instructors/facilitators, lecturers and trainers:

- a) **Experiential Learning Strategies/Scenario-based Demonstrations**—role Plays, Individual or Group Presentations and Simulation Exercises that enable participants to apply learning to real-life scenarios and situations in order to attain solutions.
- b) **Reflective Writing Activities**—Learning Journals, Diary Entries, Case Studies and Reflective Essays help assessors understand each course participant's knowledge and/or skills against the policing standards highlighted in the course outline/training guide and curriculum.
- c) **Professional Discussion Strategies** – *Socratic Debates, Question and Answer Relationships* which assess the participants' ability to correlate policing/law enforcement standards (legislation, principles and practices) expressed in a course with international and national current affairs.
- d) **Written Examinations/Tests - Selection-type or Supply-type items.** The **selection-type** items present the participants with a prearranged set of possible responses from which they are to select the most suitable answer/response for example: Multiple-Choice, True-False, Matching, Explanatory answers. However, all written examinations at the NPCJ should exclude True-False and Matching as items. The **supply-type** item requires participants to create and supply their own answers, for example: Essays, Statements, Reports and Case Studies/Analyses. These types of items should be time-bound and vetted thoroughly to ensure objectivity and correlation with what was taught.

Subsequently, each faculty/department will carry out a meticulous process of setting and marking of examinations (according to the criteria of an Examination Unit, and Primary and Secondary Examiners) aimed at ensuring fairness to all students/participants. In addition to the marking of scripts by persons who are practitioners in the area, there is provision for a student / participant to appeal and for a re-mark of the script (to be guided by the Resit and Appeals Policy).

1.1. Criterion-referenced Assessment

Assessment marking and grading will be criterion-referenced. In utilizing this strategy, the standards criteria for achievement are set in advance and made available to participants. Participant performance is evaluated according to those criteria and set standards.

In utilizing the criterion-reference assessment strategy, the NPCJ recognizes the need to educate and professionally develop law enforcement, whether newly enlisted or in-service, with the KSAs that are relevant to the serving, protecting and securing of the rights of all citizens. In developing the aforementioned strategy, it is important for assessments to be categorized by number, scheduling and weighting.

1.1.1. NUMBER, SCHEDULING AND WEIGHTING OF ASSESSMENT TASKS

Unless justified and approved by the relevant Faculty/department head, no **individual** assessment task should have a weighting of more than 50 percent of the total assessment in a module, course or programme. The scheduling of assignments and the amount of assessed work required will provide a reliable and valid achievement profile without overloading staff or participants.

1.1.2. GRADE CRITERIA

The following table (Table 1) represents the NPCJ final grade descriptors for each module, course or programme of study. They represent the participant's overall achievement in that module, course or programme.

Table 1. NPCJ's Final Grade Descriptors for Courses

Probationary Training %	In-service/ Leadership Training %	Descriptor	Firearms Training and Requalification		Descriptor	Academic Programmes/ Associate of Science Degree	Descriptor	Letter Grade	GPA Scale
			Shot Gun %	9mm, M16 %					
90 – 100	90 – 100	<i>Outstanding</i>	75 - 100	60 – 100	<i>Pass</i>	90 – 100	<i>First Class Honours</i>	A+	4.0
80 - 89	80 - 89	<i>Proficient</i>				85-89		A	3.67
75 - 79	75 - 79	<i>Above Average</i>				80 - 84		B+	3.5
70 - 74	70 - 74	<i>Average</i>	Below 70		<i>Fail</i>	75 - 79	<i>Upper Second-Class Honours</i>	B	3.0
65 – 69	65 – 69	<i>Satisfactory</i>				70 - 74	<i>Lower Second-Class Honours</i>	B-	2.67
60 - 64	60 - 64	<i>Pass</i>				65 – 69		C+	2.33
						60 - 64		C	2.0
						55-59	<i>Pass</i>	C-	1.67
						50-54		D	1.33
Below 60	Below 60	<i>Fail</i>		<i>Below 60</i>		Below 50	<i>Fail</i>	F	0

1.1.3. CREDIT HOUR

Academic Qualifications

The credit hour definition outlined herein is to be adapted by all academic units within the NPCJ.

According to the Tertiary Qualification Framework (2019), The UCJ's Distance Education Standards (2012), an academic credit is awarded as follows:

- a) Fifteen hours of lectures and seminars is equivalent to one credit.
- b) Forty-five hours of laboratory, practice, independent study, internship or apprenticeship is equivalent to one credit.

Vocational Qualifications

- a) Competency assessment instruments and competency standards continue to be used in competency-based education and training in Jamaica. Hence, a number of the NPCJ courses and programmes are benchmarked accordingly.

1.1.4. REQUIREMENTS TO ACHIEVE A PASS

The NPCJ's overall pass mark for modules and courses is 60 per cent, with the exception of the Associate of Science Degree in Criminal Justice, which has a 50 per cent pass mark and the Department of Weapons and Tactical Training's Firearms Training and Requalification Course, which has a 70 per cent pass mark. Achievement of a pass in all individual assessment tasks in a module, course or programme is usually a prerequisite for passing the overall module, course or programme. In such cases, the requirement to pass specific individual assessment items to pass the module must be clearly stated in the module and course Outline.

The Academic Board must agree to a variation to the NPCJ's overall pass mark for an already established course. In developing new courses, the NPCJ will take account of the balance between knowledge and skill acquisition and competency requirements and may mandate that a course have a higher pass mark, than the established 75, 60 or 50 percent.

1.2. Assessment Plan

In organizing your assessments for a course or programme, it is important that the Course Staff, Facilitator, Head of Faculty agree and provide a summary of both formative and summative assessment items in the course, including:

- I. the number, type, weighting, the due date and the assessment criteria and processes (rubrics, table of specification, etc.) to be applied in marking each item of assessment;
- II. a mapping of the assessment items to the learning outcomes and focus areas specified in the course or programme outline;
- III. all assessments must adhere to the '*Grading Descriptors in Section Three*' ensuring that the assessment task is clearly identified as such;

- IV. where there is a final examination, no major assessments should be due in the same week as the examination. Any deviation from this requirement must be approved by the Faculty/Department and Dean, Academic Studies;
- V. a written examination should have a standard duration (180 minutes) and be worth no less than 40%. Deviations to these must be requested with an exemption that must be approved by the head of Faculty/Department and Dean, Academic Studies;
- VI. All final examinations, tests or quizzes are to be written against a Table of Specifications

8.4. Table of Specifications

The Table of Specifications is a document that outlines the content areas, weightage and level of difficulty for each question type in an examination.

Layout of the Table of Specification

- I. Test Administration – this lays out the procedure for administering the examination – beginning, during and ending of a final examination, test or quiz
- II. Content (unit title and or focus areas) and objectives are derived from the course outline or curriculum.
- III. Item Type – this specifically states the type of questions in the examination, test or quiz. For example: Section Type – Multiple Choice Questions and Supply Type – Short Answer or Essay.
- IV. Weighting – this outlines the number of questions or sections formed from the content. Here the allocated marks per question or section are to be outlined. (see Appendix 3)

2. QUALITY ASSURANCE AND REVIEW PROTOCOLS

Quality assurance of assessments should occur at both the course and the module level. Faculties in collaboration with the CDCD are responsible for establishing a quality assurance regime for the assessment in courses and modules. This will include both internal moderation and benchmarking of assessments. Furthermore, all assessments must be maintained at every stage of the assessment cycle. Therefore, assessment tasks must be subject to routine assessment moderation processes and review through consensus on moderation practices, including peer review (another facilitator or the course or programme coordinator), to ensure that they reflect appropriate assessment design and grading. Additionally, the CDCD under the directive of the Director of Training should maintain and coordinate

professional development opportunities that are related to design, implementation and moderation of assessments for requisite staff members.

2.1. Faculty/Department Protocols

Faculties may develop faculty/department-level protocols on assessment to further define expectations relevant to professional accreditation or disciplinary practices or to clarify normal operational parameters. These protocols must be communicated with the Head of the Faculty or Department who will have dialogue with the head of the CDCD for changes to be made, then approval be given by the Quality Assurance Committee of the NPCJ.

Any such faculty/department assessment protocols must be in accordance with the Assessment Policy of NPCJ, published and communicated to participants prior to the commencement of the study period in which the module/course is being undertaken and must remain in place for the study period in which the module is being offered. Additionally, these protocols must be consistent with and subordinate with the statements outlined below:

2.1.1. Examination Units and Examiners

Each faculty/department should maintain assessment and quality assurance protocols of an ad hoc Examination Unit established by the faculty/department and include the primary and secondary examiners. This process is imperative in ensuring the credibility of the examination process offered by all faculties and departments.

2.1.2. Notification to Participants of Assessment Requirements

Assessment tasks, including marking criteria - rubric, must be clearly communicated to participants in the Lesson and/or Course Outlines at the commencement of the study period in which the module, course or programme is being undertaken.

Changes to the assessment tasks after a Course Outline has been published are only permitted with the written permission of the Head of the respective faculty/department in consultation with the head of the Curriculum Development and Coordination Unit or their delegates. Participants will be notified via a re-publication of the written course outline.

2.1.3. Attendance and Participation Requirements

Marks are not awarded for attendance. However, each faculty/department may prescribe compulsory or minimum levels of attendance for participants to satisfy the criteria to complete a course. Generally, participants must attend a minimum of 85 percent of classes.

In cases where compulsory or minimum levels of attendance are prescribed; these must be clearly stated in the Course Outlines, together with the reasons why attendance is required, the consequences of not meeting those requirements and the procedures to be followed should a participant fail to attend any required class due to illness and/or personal circumstances beyond their control. Unauthorized absences will be reported and may lead to failure to complete the course or other sanctions to be administered as determined by the JCF policies and procedures.

Participants engaged in a course of study at the NPCJ should ensure that their calendars are cleared for the period for which they will be engaged in face-to-face or virtual training at the NPCJ. If this is not possible, adequate communication should be given to the faculty/department so that some arrangements can be made to have their attendance or enrolment on the course deferred, if allowed by their, respective, Commanding Officers.

Emergency court matters that arise while a participant is on a course will be dealt with on a case-by-case basis. Such occurrences should be supported by documentation from the participant's Commanding Officer or the Court. The Instructors/Course Staff must keep attendance records for all classes in all modules of courses or programmes to ensure that compulsory or minimum attendance level is adhered to.

2.1.4. Submission of Assignments

Participants must be advised of submission requirements for assessment tasks via the directives of their trainers/facilitators, which can be on the NPCJ E-campus Learning Management System. Instructions for extended writing activities such as essays should be given two weeks before their deadlines. The length and expected content of these extended writing activities, the duration of the module or course as well as the capabilities of participants should be considered when deadlines are set. For example, a 2000-word essay may require a 2-week deadline as more research and attention to details will be paramount to its completion, whereas, a 500-word essay may require 1 hour - 3 days for completion. Following formal submission, participants may not resubmit an assessment task in an attempt to improve the result in that assessment task. However, penalties will be applied for late submission of assessment tasks.

2.1.5. *Personal Circumstances Affecting Assessment*

Special provision may be made in cases of disability, long and short-term illness, chronic and temporary illness or other major disruptions to study which affect a participant's ability to submit an assessment task. Special provisions may include extension of submission date, supplementary assessment, special examination arrangements, deferred examinations or other special adjustments. Applications for special provisions must be made in writing and must include any required supporting evidence in accordance with the Assessment Procedures and the rules laid down in the JCF Policies and Procedures.

2.1.6. *Intellectual Property and Plagiarism*

Intellectual Property:

Classroom teaching and learning activities, including lectures, discussions, presentations, etc., by both instructors and students; including PowerPoint presentations and content related handouts are considered the intellectual property of their respective author(s).

Participants registered in the course may take notes and make copies of course materials for their own educational use only. They are not permitted to reproduce or distribute lecture notes and course materials publicly for commercial or non-commercial purposes without express written consent from the authors.

1. Adapted from: (n.d.). Plagiarism. University of Oxford.

<https://www.ox.ac.uk/students/academic/guidance/skills/plagiarism#:~:text=The%20University%20defines%20plagiarism%20as,your%20work%20without%20full%20acknowledgement.>

Statement on Plagiarism:

The NPCJ defines plagiarism as “presenting, whether intentionally or not, the ideas, expression of ideas or work of others as one’s own.”¹ This can include, but not limited to:

- Reproducing or paraphrasing portions of someone else’s published or unpublished material, regardless of the source, and presenting these as one’s own without proper citation or reference to the original source;
- Submitting a take-home examination, essay, technical report or other assignment written, in whole or in part, by someone else;
- Using ideas or direct quotations, or paraphrased material, concepts, or ideas without appropriate acknowledgement in any academic assignment;
- Using another’s data or research findings;
- Failing to acknowledge sources through the use of proper citations when using another’s work and/or failing to use quotation marks; and
- Handing in substantially the same piece of work for academic credit more than once without prior written permission of the course instructor in which the submission occurs.

Reporting Plagiarism:

Any member of the NPCJ community who suspects plagiarism should report the offence to the Head of Faculty or Department immediately. The head of faculty or department will investigate the report and determine whether plagiarism has occurred. Participants who are found to have committed plagiarism will be subject to the following consequences:

First Offence:

The participant will receive a failing grade for the assignment.

The participant will be required to attend a citation workshop by the NPCJ Library.

The participant's individual report will reflect the offence.

Second Offence:

The participant will receive a failing grade for the course.

The participant will be suspended from the NPCJ for one semester, course or programme, depending on the discretion of the head of Faculty and the Director of NPCJ.

The participant's individual report and transcript will reflect the offence.

2.1.7. Feedback to Participants

Feedback is one of the most important aspects of the learning process. It enables participants to make timely and informed judgements about their performance, so that subsequent assessment can be undertaken with improved likelihood of success.

Feedback can be provided in a variety of ways, including:

- a. model answers to questions
- b. verbal comments to individuals and/or a class
- c. comments via email and/or online forums, to individuals and/or a class
- d. immediate comments on presentations and participation in class discussions
- e. preliminary discussion about an assessment task
- f. written feedback on drafts of an assessment task
- g. written comments on the NPCJ's electronic Learning Management System

2.1.8. Feedback from Participants

Participant feedback is a vital component of continuous improvement in any training or educational programme. It helps facilitators and organisers understand what aspects of the session were effective, identify areas for enhancement, and ensure that future learning experiences better meet participant needs. Feedback promotes a learner-centred environment, strengthens accountability, and contributes to overall programme quality and relevance. It is important to note that feedback from participants is treated with anonymity and is paramount to the selection of facilitators, review of programmes and tracing of participants' job performance. All feedback is channeled to the Head of Faculty or his or her designate and the Dean, Academic Studies. Participants can provide feedback through several easy and confidential methods, including:

- a. hard or online training impact evaluation forms at the end of each training
- b. training needs surveys, or interviews
- c. comments during focus group discussions.
- d. participation in tracer studies

2.2. Re-sit Procedures

Generally, a participant who fails to achieve the minimum pass mark established for an assessment or course will have one attempt to re-sit. However, participants may be given special considerations based on the areas of training they may be involved in.

2.2.1. Probationary Training

For the Probationary Training Programmes, the following procedures should be applied:

Stage 1: Notification

The participant(s) who have not achieved the minimum pass mark for an assessment – practical or written examination, will be notified of this through dialogue with the Instructor, Training Officer and Deputy Commandant.

Stage 2: Academic Warning

The participant(s) will be given an Academic Warning Letter that outlines the grades and general conduct of the particular participant, with the signature and comments from the Instructor, Training Officer and Head of Faculty. The letter also outlines the procedures for the re-sit and the actions to be taken after this re-sit is completed.

Stage 3: Revision and Counselling

Participant(s) will be engaged in a revision and counselling session to ascertain the intellectual or psychological reasons for the failure.

Stage 4: Re-sit

The re-sit stage requires participants to complete an alternative practical or written examination with different instructions and/or questions about the same topic. To pass the course, the participant(s) must obtain the minimum passing grade or higher in the re-sit, with the understanding that they will only be awarded the passing grade.

Stage 5: After the Resit

If participants have still failed the component being re-sit, they will be given an exit letter to state the terms of his or her progression or discontinuation in the course or programme.

2.2.2. In-service, Leadership and Academic Studies

For In-service and Leadership Courses and Programmes, the following procedures should be applied:

Stage 1: Notification

Participant(s) who have not achieved the minimum pass mark for an assessment (in-course assessment, practical or written examination), which have been marked by the external examiner will be notified of this through dialogue with the Facilitator, Syndicate Director and/or Course/Programme Coordinator.

Stage 2: Discussion of Weak Areas

Participants will be engaged in discussions with the Syndicate Director about the major issues found in their completion of the specific assessment.

Stage 3: Re-sit

The re-sit stage will have participants complete an alternative in-course assessment, practical or written examination that has different instructions and/or questions about the same topic(s). To have passed the course, the participant(s) must obtain the minimum passing grade or higher in the re-sit, with the understanding that they will only be awarded the passing grade.

Stage 4: After Failing the Resit

If participants have still failed the component being re-sit, they will be given one year in which they are to complete the module that correlates with the specific in-course assessment. However, for practical and written examinations, participants will have to re-sit the entire course.

***NB:** For the academic studies component, participants will be asked to **pay a fee** (to be determined by the specific department) in order to be eligible for all re-sits of in-course assessments and practical or written examinations. Participants can do as many re-sits to ensure they have passed the course, as only a pass in each core or general courses will have them progress to other courses. Elective courses, however, may be alternated and completed to achieve a pass.*

2.3. Appeals Procedures

Any appeal against an assessment by JCF serving member, for a police-related training, course or programme, decision will be dealt with in accordance with the JCF's Grievance Policy and Procedures.

2.3.1. Assessment Appeals Criteria

The following guides the appeals policy of the NPCJ.

STAGE 1:

Disagreement with an assessment decision/grade and/or Examination of the standards

STAGE 2:

Letter of Complaint to the Syndicate Director/Training Officer/Course Coordinator

STAGE 3:

Written Response Explaining or Changing Assessment Decision/Grade

STAGE 4:

Lodging the Appeals Report

STAGE 5:

Grievance Procedure

Stage 1: Disagreement with an assessment Decision/Grade

Participants are expected to identify, specifically, the disagreements by examining the course materials – course outline, presentations, training manual, etc. so as to validate the standards - learning outcomes and specific objects of the course. If there is still absolute disagreement with the assessment decision/grade, participants will move to Stage 2.

Stage 2: Letter/Email of Complaint to the Syndicate Director/Training Officer/Course Coordinator

In expressing a disagreement with an assessment, participants should write a letter/email of complaint to the Syndicate Director/Training Officer/Course Coordinator stating, specifically, their disagreement(s) and how they wish the disagreement(s) is/are to be rectified. At this stage, participants should be informed by the Syndicate Director/Training Officer/Programme/Course Coordinator the next steps which will include a review of original marking and appeal of examination grades. Participants should be warned that this review and appeal will be scheduled where they will be interviewed and be given the examination scripts to review. They should also be informed that there are three possible outcomes at this stage:

- Your original mark is lowered, so your final grade may be lower than the original grade you received.
- Your original mark is confirmed as correct, so there is no change to your grade.
- Your original mark is raised, so your final grade may be higher than the original grade you received.

Stage 3: Written Response Explaining or Changing Assessment Decision/Grade

After 5 working days, participants should be given an explanation that outlines a new decision/grade or confirms the initial decision/grade.

Stage 4: Lodging the Appeals Report

If there are still issues surfacing regarding grades, within one week of receiving the explanation from the Syndicate Director/Training Officer/Course Coordinator, the participant should lodge a grievance report using the following format:

- a) be written in chronological order (day, date, time, place of occurrence) and include the facts upon which it is based,
- b) outline the alleged wrongful act, clearly describing the harm done to the aggrieved member, and
- c) outline the resolution sought to remedy the grievance.

9.4 Grievance and Complaints Procedure

Any complaint or grievance during a programme, course or training activity should be handled according to the **NPCJ's Policy on Student Grievance and Standard Operating Procedures**.

3. EXAMINATION COORDINATION AND REGULATIONS

3.1. Examination Preparation and Procedures Regulations

These guidelines are designed to standardize the process of setting and marking written examinations across the NPCJ. The document addresses the core guidelines for setting written examination papers, writing test items, and the formatting of the completed examination paper.

Participant learning assessment is the most critical obligation of the NPCJ to all whom we instruct. The establishment and maintenance of the standard and integrity of the assessment process are therefore critical.

These guidelines are established against the background that the written examinations of faculties/departments take a wide variety of formats and have different systems of formulation. To some extent, these reflect the particular nature of the subject matter and courses being taught as well as the different perspectives of the personnel involved. While acknowledging this uniqueness it is important that all personnel involved in the process ensure that minimum standards are observed across the College. These minimum standards will contribute to the College's quest to engender a common understanding across all faculties as well as the standardization and quality assurance of examination setting, reviewing, administration, marking and analysing principles and processes.

These guidelines are for the:

- ✓ Dean, Academic Studies
- ✓ Assistant Registrar – Examination
- ✓ Heads of Faculties and Departments
- ✓ Group Inspectors
- ✓ Programme/Syndicate Directors
- ✓ Instructional Staff / Adjunct Lecturers
- ✓ Primary and Secondary Examiners
- ✓ Participants

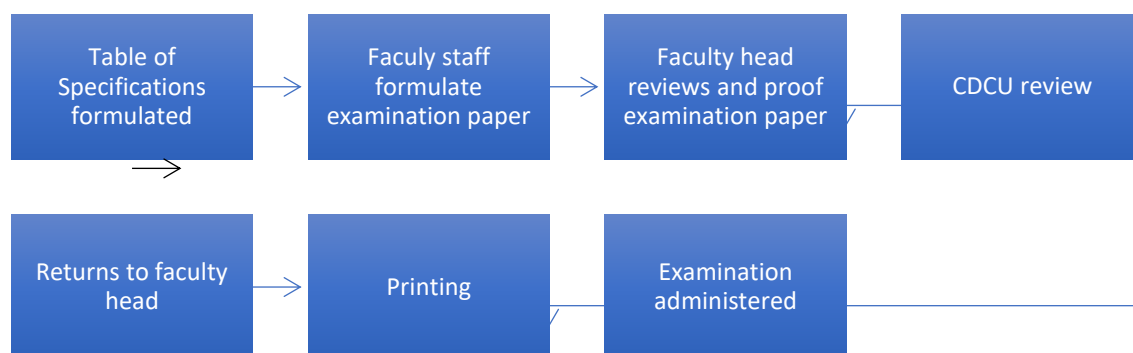
3.2. Principles for the Setting of Examination Papers

While the setting of papers will vary across faculties, due to the external agreements to which they are involved, there are core principles that all faculties must observe. These are as follow.

1. All personnel involved in the handling of examination papers must observe confidentiality of examination material and exercise due care in ensuring that unauthorized personnel do not have access to the paper and examination material.

2. All examinations are to be set against an Examination Table of Specifications that reflects the learning objectives, which are used in the Course Outline or Curriculum of a course or programme.
3. Persons charged with the responsibility of setting papers should aim for a ‘match’ between the course lesson outcomes, teaching instruction and the questions to be asked on the examination paper.
4. Rubrics must be prepared for all examination papers at the time of writing the examination. They are of particular importance when multiple markers are involved. These are also required for the review process and to facilitate validation by the CDCD to ensure that the questions asked can indeed be answered and are aligned with the learning outcomes. These also provide the examiners and instructors a means of giving participants constructive feedback on the areas for improvement.
5. Timelines for the setting of examinations: A rule of thumb must be that the process of setting examinations papers allow the review, revision, printing and packaging **TWO CLEAR WEEKS** before the examination. It is worthy of note that generally, in education, assessment is developed along with the lesson plans and are not left till the end of teaching. Most colleges and universities, require the setting of final examinations to be completed by or before the middle of the semester.
6. Observations of the timeline will enable the faculty/department to assure the intellectual level of the paper as well as the presentation. **Amendments to examination papers should not occur during the administration of the examination.**
7. Examination scripts should be password protected and emailed to the CDCD for vetting.

Figure: Examination Production Process Flow



8. No more than 10 % of any one paper should be re-used in the examination process, this is particularly important for papers used within the previous year of the examination. Re-use of recent examination items can contribute to the compromise of the examination. A question may be reused

in the instance of alterations as this can change the answer required, for example the use of scenarios or required number of items.

9. All questions should be reviewed to ensure that these address the learning outcomes taught.
10. It is important that test items be clear and unambiguous. Examination writers must ensure that test items are not constructed to trick or mislead the candidates **BUT** test the participants' learning against the objectives set for the learning material.
11. Estimating the time for the examination. Time should be allowed for participants to read the examination paper. Therefore, these are general rules that can be used to ensure that participants have enough time to complete the examination.
 - Multiple-choice and select the answer type questions – 60 seconds per question, maximum of 1.5 minute
 - Short answer questions - 3 – 5 minutes per question
 - Essay type questions - 35 – 55 minutes per question
 - Case studies should have time built into the instructions, to facilitate participants' reading at least three times as well as constructing and writing the answer(s) to the question(s).
 - Due consideration should also be given to how long a participant would take to complete a task, for example, composing a diary entry or writing an orderly room charge.
 - If the examination is done virtually, an additional thirty (30) minutes should be added to its duration so as to account for below moderate typing speed. Additionally, an extra ten (10) minutes should be given for the uploading of scripts.
12. The language used in the construction must be **precise** and **unambiguous**; grammatically correct and expressed in jargons, contexts and tones appropriate to the content of the topic.

3.3. Formatting the Examination Paper

3.3.1. Cover sheet

Any special instructions should be highlighted and placed on the front/title page of the test instrument. Use typesetting features such as bold and full caps to enable candidates focus their attention on the task/instructions. These instructions must correspond with the instructions for the various sections of the examination paper.

All examinations **submitted** to the Curriculum Development and Coordination Unit must be verified by at least two members of the faculty/department. Verification signifies that the questions

have been set against the learning outcomes and that the paper has been proofread, for errors and omissions.

An examination paper should consist of **three** components:

- (i) *the Cover Page* (Page 1) that contains all instructions pertaining to the examination;
- (ii) *the examination questions* (page 2 – end); and
- (iii) *the last page must bear the following – END OF EXAMINATION*

3.4. Preparation of the Examination Paper Coversheet

Layout font specifications	Times New Roman, (also applicable to the body of the examination paper)
a. Faculty Name	Use font size 14-16
b. Department name (where applicable)	
c. Module Code/Module Name	Use font size 12
	Use font size 12
d. Date (Month and Year)	Use font size 12
e. Duration	Use font size 12
f. Weighted value of the examination	Use font size 12
g. Total number of marks for the paper	Use font size 12

ALL Instructions for each section should be clearly indicated, on the cover page. **Section specific instructions** should again be detailed, at the beginning of each section.

Please see the accompanying example of an examination paper COVER SHEET: items in red are merely indicative.

**Faculty name: FACULTY OF RECRUIT AND PROBATIONER
TRAINING**

Course/Programme Name:

Module Title:

Date: Month and Year- **Do not insert a day**

Time:

Written / Practical Examination:

Duration of Exam:

Weighted Value of Examination: **percentage**

Total Number of Marks:

SAMPLE INSTRUCTIONS:

THIS EXAMINATION PAPER CONSISTS OF X SECTIONS AND X PAGES.

- A. ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS FROM SECTION 'A', TWO (2) QUESTIONS FROM SECTION 'B' AND ALL QUESTIONS FROM SECTION 'C'.**
- B. COMPLETE YOUR ANSWER TO SECTION 'A' ON THE QUESTION PAPER PROVIDED, (in this case participants must be provided with a place to enter examination numbers on the questions paper AND instructions to do so).**
- C. COMPLETE YOUR ANSWERS TO SECTION 'B' AND 'C' IN THE EXAMINATION ANSWER BOOKLET PROVIDED.**
- D. PLEASE WRITE YOUR IDENTIFICATION NUMBER ON:**
 - a. THE QUESTION PAPER**
 - b. THE ANSWER BOOKLET**
- E. PARTICIPANTS ARE NOT ALLOWED TO LEAVE THE EXAMINATION WITH THE EXAMINATION PAPER OR ANY ROUGH WORK PAPER.**
- F. SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS FOR THE INVIGILATOR E.G. THE USE OF CALCULATORS**
- G. SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS FOR THE PARTICIPANTS**

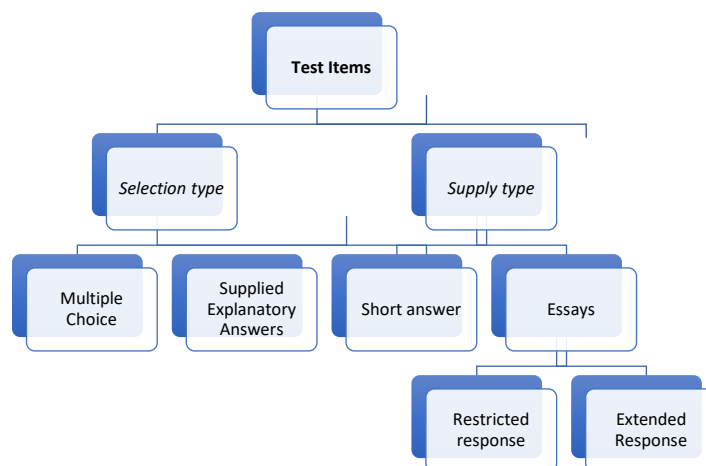
H. INDICATE ATTACHMENTS TO THE EXAM QUESTION PAPER, WHAT THEIR PURPOSE IS.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO

3.5. Guide Constructing Test Items:

In setting questions, the instructions should be short, simple and as direct as possible; with the data separated from the statement of actions / answers required. The language used in the construction must be *precise, unambiguous; grammatically correct* and expressed in **jargons, context and tone appropriate** to the content of the topic. The relevant mark values should be stated.

Figure: Graphical Representation- Types of Test Items



The following are some tips on the writing of each of the popular types of test items.

3.5.1. For Multiple-Choice items ensure that the:

- Prompt of the test item presents a single, clearly framed problem;
- Prompt is stated in simple, clear language;
- Prompt is worded so that there is no repetition of material in the alternatives;
- Prompt is stated in positive form wherever possible if negative wording is used in the prompt, it is emphasized in **bold** or by **underlining**; the intended answer is correct or clearly the best option;
- Alternatives are grammatically consistent with the prompt and comparable in form;
- Alternatives are free from verbal clues to the correct answer;
- Distracters are plausible and attractive to the uninformed;
- Avoid the tendency to make the correct answer longer than the distracters;

- Beware of grammatical giveaways. For example, if the prompt ends with the word “an” and only one or two options begin with a vowel, then the candidates can easily eliminate the distracters ;
- Avoid the over use of “*none of the above,*” “*some of the above,*” “*all of the above,*” phrases which usually scream out that they are the correct answer;
- Order the response choices alphabetically, dates chronologically, and formulas in terms of complexity. This logical sequence will help participants locate choices.

3.5.2. For supply type questions (Essay and Short Answer Questions)

- Be clear about the mental processes that the participants need to use to answer the essay. Generally, in Policing, there is a need to think critically, judge and analyze, it is therefore recommended that we use verbs demanding higher order cognitive skills.
- If the intention is that a supply type question have a restricted length this must be specified, word limits being preferred to, instructions to write briefly.
- The question is written in such a way that the task is clear and unambiguous.
- Start essay questions with such words and phrases as *compare, contrast, predict what will happen if...*
- Restrict the use of supply type question particularly essay to learning objectives that cannot be examined with the use of supply type questions.
- Avoid using optional items, such as allowing participants to complete 2 of 7 and so forth. This will decrease the test validity and well as the ability to make comparisons between participants work.
- Ensure that the question relates to the instructional/ learning objectives.

3.5.3. Supply-type items include:

Short answers, and essays (restricted responses, unrestricted responses) as well as case studies etc.

✓ **For Short-Answer items ensure that:**

- The item calls for a single, brief answer
- The item has been written as a direct question or a well-stated incomplete sentence
- The desired response is related to the main point of the item.

3.5.4. Constructing Essay Questions

Essay categories include:

- **Written response** items call for a fact or opinion or as much as a candidate can recall about a certain topic
- **Restricted response essays:**
The candidate responds to an unfamiliar problem by recalling relevant concepts, facts, and principles; organizes these recollections and writes a coherent response. These are usually a page or less in length.
- **Extended-response essays:**
These differ from restricted response essays in that the questions posed are more complex, requiring longer answers.

3.6. Rubrics

According to Brookhart 2013, “A rubric is a coherent set of criteria for participants’ work that includes descriptions of levels of performance quality on the criteria” (pg. 4). Rubrics are quite instrumental in guiding the responses expected from students/participants for a written or oral assessment. They give a more organized structure to the observation of trainers/ facilitators and add valuable feedback to participants. Rubrics can be difficult to create but they often make it easier for grading fairly and credibly. In summary, a rubric is a scoring tool that explicitly represents the performance expectations for an assignment or piece of work.

Rubrics can be altered to facilitate the type of assessment criteria that are pertinent to gauge participants’ knowledge and skills. Therefore, the sample rubric Appendix 1, can be used as a guide and not necessarily the standard.

The following sample categories maybe considered for the Rubric:

1. Content – (Required information provided)
2. Organization/Expression
3. Presentation

3.7. Submitting Draft Examination Papers for Review by the CDCD

The examination paper should be submitted to the CDCD in ‘**ready for reproduction**’ format and be accompanied by a rubric (for essay-type questions), answer key and table of specification.

These examination papers should be submitted for review, **TWO WEEKS** before the administering of the paper to participants. **ONE WEEK** may be given for short courses and workshops. This review involves

participation of at least TWO members from the Quality Assurance Desk of the unit (inclusive of the Dean) who is of a higher rank than the participants of the examination to be reviewed. If the examination is slated for participants of a higher rank than those in the unit, external member(s) – such as a head of a faculty/department will be asked to participate in this review.

Examinations will be reviewed on the basis of:

1. *Validity* – Questions should be based on the objectives of the topic presented in the course outline or curriculum.

1 Brookhart, S. (2013). How to create and use rubrics for formative assessment and grading, pg. 4.

2. *Consistency* – The pertinent elements of a question should be sufficiently structured to ensure only one answer can be given.
3. *Time* – appropriate allocation of time for each question and section of the paper is given.
4. *Transparent Marking Criteria* – Marks allocated for items are logically decided upon and allows for participants to have a clear idea of what the question expects of them.
5. *Objectivity* – Questions should be written in language familiar with participants, match the manner in which the content was taught and according to the learning outcomes expected. Questions should allow for a fair coverage of items and opportunities to get full marks. For example: participants may be asked to state five out of nine advantages of Committal Proceedings.

The Quality Assurance Desk must ensure that special instructions are clearly outlined for the packaging and administering of examination; these include but are not limited to:

- Special instructions for the photocopying of the examination paper e.g. **do not copy back and front.**
- Indicate all attachments needed for the examination / to the exam question paper, for example: diagrams, sheets for diary notes, answer paper or booklets, etc.
- Supply and number questions of the exam question paper.

3.8. Security of Test Bank and Final Examination Papers

It is important that each faculty/department and the Assistant Registrar – Examination should design a scheme for securing their question test banks and examination papers. The following are simple suggestions to enable the protection of such.

- A. Password – protect all examination documents and files held on computers. The password for the examination script should be shared in separate emails.
- B. Store examination banks and papers on jump-drives and in Cloud facilities, rather than on just email storage, under no circumstances must they be stored on communally used computers and laptops.
- C. All working copies should be stored securely and shredded under supervision when no longer needed.

3.9. Examination Administration

3.9.1. Packaging and Collection of Examination Scripts for Administering to the Participants

In administering an examination, there MUST be at least three personnel invigilating and moderating the flow of the examination. The number of persons may differ as it relates to the type and duration of course or programme; however, ALL examination MUST include an Examination Officer and the appropriate ratio of Invigilators. Typically, the examination administration personnel should include one Examination Officer, one Senior Invigilator and one Invigilator. Their responsibilities will include:

3.9.2. Examination Officer

The examination Officer will be responsible for the packaging and administration of the examination script to the invigilator. He or she also oversees and supervises the examination and share the examination rules and regulations and the instructions on the respective examination script to invigilators and candidates.

3.9.3. Senior Invigilator

The senior invigilator is responsible for leading the team of invigilators in conducting internal and external examinations for participants, ensuring that all regulatory requirements and school policy and procedures for the conduct of examinations are strictly adhered to and met at all times.

3.9.4. Invigilator

The invigilator is responsible for the administration of examination scripts to the candidates and the overall conduct, requests and offering of assistance to candidates. They are also expected to organize seating of and the collection of scripts from the candidates.

Face to Face Examination

- Exam scripts must be printed on booklets for all levels of training, then placed in a sealed (with an adhesive tape) envelope and administered to the Examination Officer.
- Envelop should include:

- Course Code/Abbreviated Name of Course at the top right-hand corner
- Date and time of Examination centre-top aligned
- Name of Facilitator centre-middle aligned
- Invigilators should pull the sealed envelope ONLY on the day of the examination in front of the examinees.
- All examinees should be encouraged to put their identification number on ALL PAGES of their examination paper/answer booklet

Virtual

Multiple Choice Select an Answer-type Items and Short Answer ...

- Should be done using a quiz-like, form-type ICT application – Quizlet, Google Forms, Survey Monkey, E-campus etc.

Extended Writing – Essays, Reports, etc....

- Should be done on a Word Processing Software– Google Docs, Microsoft Word, etc and uploaded to the E-campus.
- Application of a remote proctoring should be done to close tabs, share screen, view room space, record examination period, test microphones, access webcam, keyboard and mouse – remote proctoring applications may include: Zoom, TeamViewer, Meet, Microsoft Teams, WebEx, etc.
- Any suspicious behaviour should be reported/recorded/documented for the following persons to access:
 - ✓ Head of Faculty/department
 - ✓ Dean, Academic Studies
 - ✓ ACP, Training

Practical Activities and Examination – Role Plays, Presentations

- Should be pre-recorded and uploaded to the E-campus.
- Appropriate checklists and rubrics MUST accompany these activities.
- Group, driving, range, tactical Activities should be done face to face.

3.9.5. Examination Rules and Regulations

These regulations apply to all participants who are enrolled in a course or programme that requires a written examination. The rules and regulations outlined are expectations for the conduct of participants when they are taking written examinations face to face or virtually.

Requirements for Admittance to the Examination Room

- Candidates should arrive at the examination room at least 15 minutes before the scheduled examination. Candidates arriving 30 minutes after the scheduled time for an examination will not be admitted to the examination room.
- Candidates are expected to fill in the examination slip, before beginning the examination.
- Candidates should indicate the question numbers which they have attempted during the examination, in the exact order in which they have attempted them and should be placed on answer booklets.
- It is imperative that all candidates bring the following items to the examination room. (Note that for virtual examinations, participants will keep their cameras on and demonstrate proof of their surroundings.)
 - a) Examination Card/Timetable
 - b) Photographic Identification Card – Participant ID, Police ID, Driver’s Licence, Passport or National ID
- Candidates are required to comply with all examination instructions given by the Examination Officer/Invigilator before and during an examination.
- Candidates are not allowed to take to their examination desk, or use any material such as: textbooks, notes, electronic devices – mobile phones, tablets or laptops, unless the device will be used to take the examination or help the invigilator or moderator in invigilating the examination space.
- A candidate must not assist, attempt to assist, obtain or attempt to obtain assistance from any candidate or person outside of the invigilator.
- All enquiries or need for assistance must be directed to the invigilator or moderator.
- All candidates are to remain silent from the instance they enter the examination room to their exit. All requests and need for assistance must be made with the raising of a hand and done in the lowest pitch.

- Candidates are to remain in the examination room for one hour before any requests for handing in the examination script and leaving to be accepted. Candidates must not leave the room without permission from the invigilator/moderator. If a candidate must leave the examination room, he or she must be accompanied by an invigilator or use the remote proctoring software to time-out the examination screen and have candidate declare their credibility in avoiding cheating.
- All smart devices (mobile phones, smart watches, Bluetooth earphones, computerized calculators, etc.) should be switched off before entering the examination room. These items are not permitted to be taken to the desk of any candidate under any circumstances.
- Candidates are not allowed to have briefcases, bags, books, mobile phones or anything pertaining to content for a course in the examination room. Device screens that are being used to complete examinations should be clear and free from any possible access to information which may assist in the completion of the examination.
- Generally, no hats, coats and/or bullet proof vests are permitted in an examination room. In face to face examination rooms, no firearms are allowed.
- Unless specifically stated by the department or faculty or the requirement for the course or programme, the NPCJ does not implement a dress code for its examination. However, candidates are to ensure that their attires are appropriate and do not cause a distraction to fellow candidates and are in line with appropriate dress codes.

After the Examination

Candidates should:

- Stop writing as soon as instructions are given to do so;
- Not leave their desk until instructions have been given to do so; and
- Be cognizant that examination script(s) remain the property of the NPCJ and will not be returned to them.

Breach of the Examination Regulation

- Cheating means an attempt to benefit oneself or another by deceit, fraud or other breaches of the examination regulations.
- If any candidate is adjudged by the Quality Assurance Committee (an ad hoc committee of the Academic Board) to have violated any of the regulations of the examinations or any other way to have acted improperly, a report will be sent to the Management Advisory Committee who has

the power to declare the candidate's examination null and void or any part thereof. The Management Advisory Committee may also publish their name as having been deprived of their examination, either wholly or in part having violated the regulations of examinations. They will also have the power to exclude the candidate from the examination for a period not exceeding two years.

- In case of impersonation, the impersonator and the individual being impersonated will be liable to permanent exclusion from the particular course or programme.
- Where the invigilator suspects a candidate of cheating, he or she will alert the Examination Officer and the other invigilator and the necessary investigation done.
- Where found at fault, the cheater will be given a verbal warning and a report made by the Examination Officer.
- Each alleged case of cheating will be considered by the Quality Assurance Committee under the directive of the Academic Board.

3.9.6. Packaging/Submitting of Examination Scripts for Marking

It is important that the integrity of all examination script is maintained during the process of marking. As such, the following guidelines should be practised for packaging and submitting the scripts to the primary and secondary markers.

Face to Face

- Exam scripts must be collected and re-packaged in envelope sealed and bearing the following:
 - Course Code/Abbreviated Name of Course at the top right-hand corner
 - Date of Examination centre-top aligned
 - Name of Facilitator centre-middle aligned
- This must then be given to the Primary Examiner who will return for delivery to the Secondary Examiner
- Grading must be aligned to the grading criteria of the NPCJ (see 3.2.2 above)

Virtual

Exam scripts must be downloaded and packaged in a password encrypted Zip Folder bearing the following:

- Course Code/Abbreviated Name of Course
- Date of Examination
- Name of Facilitator
- This must then be given to the Primary Examiner who will return for delivery to the Secondary Examiner in a similar fashion. Except the word 'Marked' should be in the title.
- Grading must be aligned to the grading criteria of the NPCJ (see Assessment Policy)

3.9.7. Analysis of Assessments (see Appendix 3)

For this aspect, the tabular form is to be presented, which will form part of the Course Report. The Analysis of Report should have the following areas:

Categories of Assessment

- This outlines whether the assessment was formative – while classes were happening and clear and immediate feedback was accessible by participants

Type of Assessment

- In this row, a list of all the types of assessments are to be written. This list should be as is laid out in the course outline/curriculum

Date of Assessment

- For this row, it is expected that the exact dates that the assessment was collected is represented.

Grade Criteria

- The grading criteria used for this row MUST be in accordance with the particular courses and programmes as laid out in the Assessment Policy.

Briefly describe the OVERALL ASSESSMENT Process.

- Levels of difficulty/comprehension
- Strengths and Weaknesses encountered with assessment (time, duration, prompts/questions) and participants.

3.10. Course/Programme Report

Course/programme reports offer an overview of a pre-defined learning programme-like compliance training; they indicate the participants' progress through courses, videos, assessments and keep up with high-level metrics like average assessment scores and competencies demonstrated (Downes, 2016).

This should accompany all course and programmes and follow the template in Appendix

3.11. Transcript Request and Issuance Procedures

A transcript is the complete participant academic record which includes the relevant signatories – ACP Training and the Registrar. It should be printed on official transcript paper, delivered by secure electronic transmission or printed and handed to the requested parties – subject of the records and other official institutions and organizations.

3.11.1. Requesting Transcripts

The following procedures account for the requesting of NPCJ transcripts. A transcript request will become valid upon receiving the following:

- a) a written and signed request from the participant;
- b) payment of the transcript fee must be received before release of any transcript.
- c) recipient address

3.11.2. Issuing Transcripts

The following procedures account for the requesting of NPCJ transcripts. Transcripts will be issued:

- a. After the fee for the application of a transcript is paid
 - b. when transcript request is completed as described above
 - c. to correct an error discovered on the previously issued transcript
 - d. when authorized by the ACP Training and the Registrar
 - e. when a subpoena is presented to the Registrar of NPCJ
 - i. Registrar will consult with the ACP Training.
- NB: an exception to this process: specific Court Order request.
- f. to parents/legal guardian, upon written request from participant.
 - g. to another educational institution to which a participant has sought admission.
2. Transcripts of the deceased will be released to a family member if they can provide documentation of participant death and of their relationship to the deceased participant. The

family member must complete a transcript request form, provide required documentation and pay the transcript fee.

3. Transcripts will be issued showing FULL academic record.

4. LEGISLATIVE AUTHORITY/GUIDING PRINCIPLES

- 4.1. This Policy shall be read in conjunction with the Jamaica's Copyright Act 1993; Jamaica Copyright Amendment Act 2015; the JCF Training Policy, NPCJ Student Handbook, NPCJ Student Code of Conduct, and programme and course outlines.

5. EDUCATIONAL INITIATIVES

- 5.1. The NPCJ will provide educational initiatives to promote assessment quality and prevent assessment unreliability, invalidity and incredibility. These initiatives may include workshops, seminars, online resources, and assessment tutorials.

6. REVIEW AND REVISION

- 6.1. The NPCJ is committed to maintaining the highest standards of assessment. This Quality Assessment Policy and Standard Operating Procedures will be reviewed biannually to ensure its effectiveness and relevance. Any necessary revisions will be made in consultation with relevant stakeholders, including students, faculty, staff, academic/advisory boards, and certification and accreditation bodies.

APPENDIX 1: SAMPLE RUBRICS

Sample Grading Rubric for an Essay (Total Marks 100)

Written communication (50 points)	
Organization	
	○ Inadequate (10 points): There appears to be no organization of the essay's contents.
	○ Needs Improvement (15 points): Organization of the essay is difficult to follow, due to inadequate transitions and/or rambling format.
	○ Adequate (20 points): The essay can be easily followed. A combination of the following is apparent: Basic transitions are used; a structured format is used.
	○ Proficient quality (25 points): The essay can be easily followed. A combination of the following is apparent: Effective transitions are used; a professional format is used.
Mechanics and grammar	
Correctness of facts	
	○ Inadequate (10 points): Sentences and paragraphs are difficult to read and understand due to poor grammar or mechanics
	○ Needs improvement (15 points): The essay contains numerous grammatical and mechanical errors.
	○ Adequate (20 points): The essay contains minimal grammatical or mechanical errors.
	○ Proficient quality (25 points): The essay is clear and concise and contains no grammatical or mechanical errors.
Content (50 points) (specific to the question asked)	
	○ Inadequate (10 points): Most facts are wrong.
	○ Needs improvement (15 points): Some facts are wrong.
	○ Adequate (20 points): Procedural details are generally correct.
	○ Proficient quality (25 points): All facts are correct, and the procedure is both concise and complete.
Critical Thinking	
	○ Inadequate (10 points): Did not address key issues with substantial analysis
	○ Needs improvement (15 points): Addressed the issues, but provided very limited analysis
	○ Adequate (20 points): Addressed the main issues, but left required greater depth of analysis.
	○ Proficient quality (25 points): Addressed all issues with full analysis

JR/GM-2014/ Revised 2018

6.1.1. Sample Grading Rubric for an Oral Presentation (Total Marks 15)

CRITERIA	LEVELS OF PERFORMANCE			
	Excellent - 5 marks	Good - 4 marks	Average - 3 marks	Poor - 1-2 marks
Presentation [Publication]	Holds attention of entire audience with the use of direct eye contact, seldom looking at notes. Speaks fluently and with variation.	Consistent use of direct eye contact with audience, but still returns to notes. Mostly speaks with fluency and variation.	Displays minimal eye contact with audience, while reading mostly from the notes Speaks in an uneven volume with little or no inflection	Holds no eye contact with audience, as entire report is read from notes Speaks in low volume and/ or monotonous tone, which causes audience to disengage
Content	Provides clear purpose and thesis; relevant examples, facts, and/or statistics; supports conclusions/ideas with evidence	Has somewhat clear purpose and thesis; some examples, facts, and/or statistics that support the subject; includes some data or evidence that supports conclusions	Attempts to define purpose and thesis; provides weak examples, facts, and/ or statistics, which do not adequately support the subject; includes very thin data or evidence	Does not clearly define subject and purpose; provides weak or no support of subject; gives insufficient support for ideas or conclusions
Expression & Organization	Very good use of language though there may be the occasional lapse in accuracy. There are no errors in grammar, mechanics, and/or spelling.	Effective and accurate use of language though there may be a few lapses. Some ability to use language accurately and effectively but with some inconsistency in accurate usage. There are few errors in grammar, mechanics, and/or spelling, but they do not interfere with understanding.	Frequent, inaccurate use of language. OR: Too little information presented to make an assessment There are several errors in grammar, mechanics, and/or spelling.	Inability to use language accurately OR: Insufficient information presented in some area There are numerous errors in grammar, mechanics, and/or spelling.

APPENDIX 2: ANALYSIS OF ASSESSMENTS**Course Name:** _____**Faculty/Department:** _____ **Date of Course:** _____**# of Participants:** _____

CATEGORIES OF ASSESSMENTS			FORMATIVE ASSESSMENTS				EXAMINATION
DATE OF ASSESSMENT			January 6, 2021	January 11, 2021	January 13, 2021	January 22, 2021	January 29, 2021
TYPE OF ASSESSMENT			Role Play	Group Presentation	Practical	Essay	Practical Examination
GRADING CRITERIA			RATE FOR EACH CRITERIA AND ASSESSMENT				
Basic Training	Letter Grade	GPA Scale					
90 – 100	A+	4.0					
80 - 89	A	3.5					
75 - 79	B+	3.0					
70 - 74	B	2.5					
65 – 69	C+	2.0					
60 - 64	C	1.5					
Below 60	F	0					
% Completed Assessment							
% PASS							

Briefly describe the OVERALL ASSESSMENT outcomes.

- (1) Levels of difficulty/comprehension
- (2) Strengths and Weaknesses encountered with assessment (time, duration, prompts/questions) and participants

APPENDIX 3: TEST ADMINISTRATION AND TABLE OF SPECIFICATION

TEST ADMINISTRATION {Adjust to match the manner in which the examination is to be administered}

Course Title: CCTV Surveillance Operations Training

Institution/Division/Formation:

Type of Assessment: Written Examination

Date of Assessment: April 2021

Level Being Assessed: Newly Appointed CCTV Surveillance Operators

Number of Participants to be assessed:

Number of Copies of papers printed:

Assessment Venue:

Duration of Assessment: 3 hours

Time Start

Time End:

Resources Needed for the Assessment: Pens, Pencils, Question Papers, Foolscap, Stop Watch/Clock, Staple Machines,

Special Instructions: Participants are not permitted to enter the room with extraneous material. Participants will not be permitted to leave the exam room during the last fifteen minutes of the exam.

Procedures at the Beginning and During the Test

1. Arrangement of room/preparation of equipment to be used.

The room is to remain sterile until the invigilator enters the room. All equipment for the administering of the exam should be sourced and made available. A clock should be placed at the centre of the room visible to all trainees. The room should be arranged in the traditional row-and-column seating with no more than 8 seats per row, evenly spaced.

2. Distribution of Papers.

The test paper and foolscap should be distributed fifteen minutes (15) before the start of the examinations. Foolscap must be distributed first. The test paper should be distributed after all the trainees have received their foolscap.

3. Instructions

Participants should be notified of the following instructions.

- You should spend ten minutes (10) reading through the paper before starting to write your answers.
- You must write your examination number on each sheet of answer booklet.
- Follow all instructions for each section and answer the required questions.
- No cellular phone is allowed on your person during the examination.
- There should be no corresponding with each other once the examination starts.
- All concerns must be brought to the attention of the invigilator by raising your hand.
- Participants caught cheating will be expelled from the examination.
- Participants must not leave the room within the first hour and the last fifteen minutes.
- Select the correct letter for Multiple Choice

4. Timing

The test must start at 9:30 am and finish at 1:00 pm. A time check must be given every half-an-hour interval.

5. Invigilation of test/exam

Invigilator(s) must remain in the room throughout the examination. It is expected that the invigilator(s) will move around in the room during the examination period and maintain the integrity of the examination.

Procedures at the End of the Test.

1. Collection of Papers

At the end of the time allotted participants should be instructed to stop working. Exam papers must be collected at the end from each trainee. Participants must not leave the examination room until the last paper is collected.

2. Concluding Comments

Thank the members for their participation and co-operation. Then allow participants to leave the examination room.

3. Handing over of Papers

Examination papers must be properly secured and delivered to the office of the Curriculum Coordination Team, who should then check and sign-off on the number of papers received.

Table of Specifications (TOS)

Course Title: CCTV Surveillance Operations Training

Level: Newly Appointed CCTV Surveillance Operators

Type of Test: End of Course Test

Date: April 2021

Content/Topic	Objective: Upon completing this examination, participants should demonstrate their ability to:	Taxonomy: Cognitive Affective Psychomotor	Item	Weighting
Public Interaction Policy	- Discuss the importance of Good Customer Service; - Demonstrate high standards of professionalism during the execution of their duties, especially when they interact with the public.		Selection Type (MCQ) Supply Type (SA)	2 items@ 1 mark Ques. 1,2 1 item@ 5 marks Ques. 3A Total – 7 marks
Human Rights and Use of Force Policy	- Explain the principles of the Use of Force policy. - Explain the terms ‘Human Rights’, ‘Force’, ‘Less Lethal’ and ‘Lethal Force’. - Discuss when a firearm is deemed ‘Used’. - State factors to be considered whenever members to the JCF resort to the lawful use of force.		Selection Type (MCQ)	2 items @ 1 mark Ques. 3,4 Total – 2 marks
			Selection Type (MCQ)	2 items @ 1 mark Ques. 5,6

				Total – 2 marks
			Selection Type (MCQ)	2 items @ 1 mark Ques. 7,8 Total – 2 marks {Add as many rows as needed. Please remember this should reflect the topics being tested. Also, the topics and objectives should be taken from the course outline.}

APPENDIX 4: CANDIDATE CONSENT AND REVIEW FORM*Information for candidates*

The following information explains what may happen following a review of marking and/or subsequent appeal.

Once your Syndicate Director or Course Coordinator submits your request for a review of the original marking, and a subsequent appeal for one of your examinations after your course grade has been issued, there are three possible outcomes:

- Your original mark is lowered, so your final grade may be lower than the original grade you received.
- Your original mark is confirmed as correct, so there is no change to your grade.
- Your original mark is raised, so your final grade may be higher than the original grade you received.

Candidate number: _____

Candidate name: _____

Course Name: _____

Details of Review: *[click on all possible reasons for review]*

- i. Review of original marking of examination script
- ii. Appeal for examination grade

☐
☐

Final Grade Received: _____

Resit Required: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Name and Signature of Examination Review Committee:

1. Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

2. Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

I am satisfied that the review process was unbiased and included a complete review of the examination script. I am also satisfied that the final grade received was satisfactory.

Signed: Date: _____